Lab 01 — Set Up Your Claude Video Studio

Course: Agentic AI for Video Creation (C436)

Day 1 · Topic 1 · about 30 minutes · slides 57–62

Agent: Claude Desktop — skills, the Higgsfield connector and a project

Features: Higgsfield sign-up · five video skills · Higgsfield MCP connector · a Claude project with instructions and knowledge · LahLah Video installed by Claude

The story so far

Priya has bought the studio a Claude plan and a Higgsfield plan. Before anyone writes a line, you set up the studio once: the skills that hold the studio's know-how, the connector that lets Claude drive Higgsfield, a project for Episode 1, and an editor on your laptop.

Your goal

Install the tools once so every later lab is one prompt away: Claude calls the right skill and the right Higgsfield tool by name.

You'll produce

A Claude project "Kopi & Coins – Ep1 micro-drama (TikTok)" with five skills on, Higgsfield connected, the studio brief in its knowledge, and LahLah Video open on your computer

What is in this folder

- `assets/skills/storytelling.zip`
- `assets/skills/storyboard.zip`
- `assets/skills/video-script.zip`
- `assets/skills/higgsfield-video.zip`
- `assets/skills/platform-publish.zip`
- `assets/project-ep01-setup.pdf`
- `assets/studio-brief.pdf`
- `assets/setup-checklist.pdf`
- `prompts.html` — open in a browser; one click copies each prompt into Claude
- `prompts.pdf` — the same prompts, printable
- `evidence/checklist.pdf` — what to capture as proof
- `../prompt-builder.html` — build your own prompt for any stage, genre and platform

Why each step matters

- A skill is a folder with a SKILL.md file: the studio's way of doing one job, written once. Claude loads it only when the task matches, or when you name it — "use the storyboard skill". Five skills cover the whole pipeline: storytelling, storyboard, video-script, higgsfield-video and platform-publish.
- A connector is an MCP server Claude can call. Higgsfield's connector gives Claude tools such as balance (credits left), models_explore (which video models exist today), presets_show (camera presets), generate_image, generate_video_batch and jobs_wait (status and result links). Every MCP generation spends Higgsfield credits, even on "unlimited" plans.
- A project keeps one video's instructions, files and chats together. Project knowledge has no folders, so the studio uses filename prefixes instead: 01-idea__, 02-storyboard__, 03-script__, 04-assets__, 05-edit__, 06-publish__.
- The Higgsfield side mirrors the project: a folder in Higgsfield Assets with the same name. Every reference still and every clip for Episode 1 is moved into it, so nothing lives outside Higgsfield and anyone can trace a shot to its job.
- Claude is already on your laptop, so let Claude install the editor. The install script picks the right .dmg or .exe, copies it and clears the macOS download warning — no hunting through download pages.

Step by step

1. **Sign up for Higgsfield** — Open the sign-up link on the labs page and start the free 3-day trial (100 credits, usable through the Claude connector), or a paid plan.
2. **Turn on code and files** — Claude Desktop: Settings > Capabilities > Code execution and file creation.
3. **Upload five skills** — Customize > Skills > + > Upload a skill. Upload each ZIP in assets/skills and switch it on.
4. **Connect Higgsfield** — Customize > Connectors > + > Add custom connector. Name Higgsfield, URL https://mcp.higgsfield.ai/mcp, Connect, sign in.
5. **Create the project** — + New Project "Kopi & Coins – Ep1 micro-drama (TikTok)". Paste the instructions from project-ep01-setup.pdf; add studio-brief.pdf to its knowledge.
6. **Test tools and skills** — Prompt A calls balance, models_explore and presets_show (no generation). Prompt B lists the skills in pipeline order.
7. **Install LahLah Video** — Prompt C: Claude detects Mac or Windows, runs the one-line installer and opens the editor.

The prompts

PROMPT A — test the Higgsfield tools (no generation)

> Check the Higgsfield connector without generating anything.
>
> 1. Call balance and tell me my credits and plan.
> 2. Call models_explore and recommend two video models for a 9:16, 5-second image-to-video shot: one cheap low-res draft model and one final-quality model, with the credit cost of each at 480p or 720p and at 1080p.
> 3. Call presets_show and list ten camera presets by name.

> List every Higgsfield tool you can call, one line each. Do not call any generate_ tool.

PROMPT B — test the skills

> List the skills you can use in this project. For each one give: its name, the job it does, the words in my request that would make you load it, and what it hands to the next skill.
>
> Then tell me the order the five video skills run in for one episode, from idea to publish.

PROMPT C — install LahLah Video with Claude

> Install LahLah Video on this computer. Detect whether I am on macOS or Windows. On macOS run: curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/alfredang/LahLahVideo/main/install/install.sh | bash . On Windows run in PowerShell: irm https://raw.githubusercontent.com/alfredang/LahLahVideo/main/install/install.ps1 | iex . Show me each command before you run it, then confirm that LahLah Video opens.

Check your work

- □ Five skills appear under Customize > Skills and are switched on.
- □ Higgsfield shows as connected, and Prompt A returned a real credit balance from the balance tool.
- □ Claude named a low-res draft model and a final model from models_explore, with costs, and ten presets from presets_show.
- □ The project exists with its instructions saved and studio-brief.pdf in its knowledge.
- □ Claude listed the five skills in pipeline order.
- □ LahLah Video opens on your computer.

If it goes wrong

- **Claude answers without calling a tool** — In the chat, open + > Connectors and switch Higgsfield on. If it still fails, Disconnect and Connect again.
- **"Authorization with the MCP server failed"** — The sign-in expired. Disconnect the Higgsfield connector, Connect, sign in again.
- **A skill upload is rejected** — Upload the ZIP as shipped; it holds one folder named exactly like the skill.
- **macOS says the app cannot be opened** — Run Prompt C again so the installer clears the quarantine flag, or right-click the app and choose Open.

Stretch

- Ask Claude: "Which Higgsfield tools could spend credits or post publicly?" Add a rule to the project instructions that Claude must ask before calling any of them.

> **Set up once, then speak in jobs, not steps: "use the storyboard skill on the approved script" beats twenty lines of instructions.**

Next

Lab 02 — Plan the Story with Claude and the Storytelling Skill. Keep what you produced — the next lab starts from it.

Safety

Use only this lab's fictitious characters and data and your own accounts. Never paste an API key, password or personal data into a prompt, a file you share or a screenshot. Nothing is uploaded publicly; upload plans stay private until a person approves.